

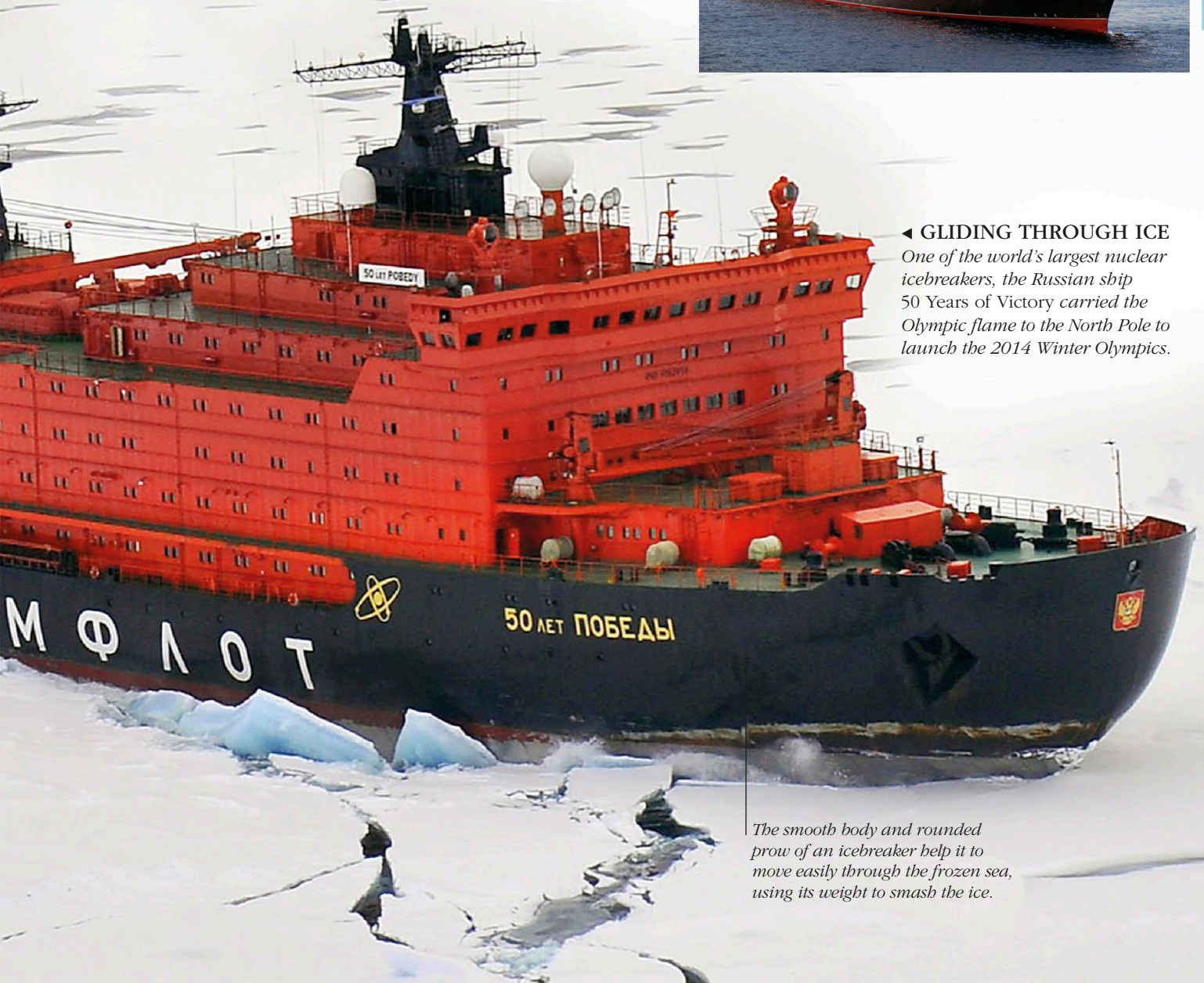


JET PROPULSION

Some boats are driven along by a powerful whoosh of water. These “pump-jet” boats, or jet skis, have a device called an impeller. Hidden inside a tube in the hull, the impeller draws in water through an intake, then shoots it out at the back to drive the boat along. Jet-propelled boats are very fast.

HYBRID POWER

In most ships, engines turn the propellers directly, but more and more naval vessels and a few passenger liners, such as the *Queen Mary 2* (right), turn their propellers in a different way. In these “hybrid” vessels, the engine powers electrical generators. These run electric motors, which turn the propellers. Hybrid ships are more energy-efficient than standard vessels.



◀ GLIDING THROUGH ICE

One of the world's largest nuclear icebreakers, the Russian ship 50 Years of Victory carried the Olympic flame to the North Pole to launch the 2014 Winter Olympics.

The smooth body and rounded prow of an icebreaker help it to move easily through the frozen sea, using its weight to smash the ice.